

GREEDY VS NEEDY

The Greedy

Processor: The Athlon XP 1800+ (1.53 GHz) is the chip if you want maximum power. However, you have to back it up with the best components in the market.

Motherboard: The ASUS A7V266-E. Nothing comes close to it in terms of pure performance; it will let loose all the horses that the Athlon XP 1800+ has to offer.

RAM: Nothing less than 512 MB of DDR SDRAM will do.

Hard drives: 80 GB (7,200 rpm)

Monitor: 21-inch Sony CPD G520

Graphics card: ASUS V8200 GeForce 3 Deluxe. This card is the fastest available to date and will ensure that the Athlon XP 1800+ will not be bottlenecked.

The Needy

Processor: Unimpressed by raw speed and power? Looking for value for money? Package the Duron 1.1 GHz with the components listed below and it will take care of all your applications with relative ease.

Motherboard: The KM133 based DFI AM36EC.

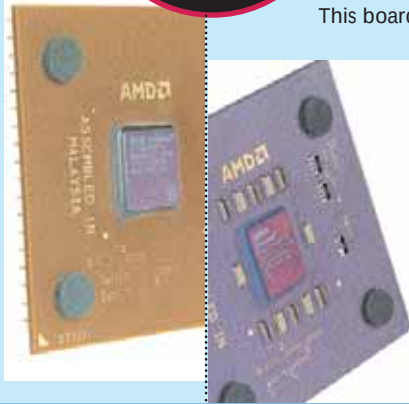
This board gives decent onboard video and audio along with the choice of adding an AGP card in the future.

RAM: 256 MB of SDRAM. This is sufficient for most applications and is reasonable considering the reasonable price of RAM.

Hard drives: 20 GB (5,400 rpm)

Monitor: 15-inch Viewsonic E53

Graphics card: For most purposes, an onboard graphics card will suffice, but if you want a separate one, any TNT2 M64 16 MB card will do.



46 seconds, whereas the Pentium III 1.13 GHz took 10 minutes 18 seconds. In the other benchmarks, the scores logged by the Duron 1.1 GHz were almost at par with the Pentium III 1.13 GHz (196 fps in normal mode in Quake III Arena as compared to 202 fps logged by the Pentium III 1.13 GHz).

Rating: B
Verdict: A good buy. The Duron coupled with a low-cost VIA-based platform will give you a PC that can give the big boys some serious trouble.

The worthy mentions

Pentium 4 (Willamette)

Pentium 4 is the flagship processor from Intel today. The first to hit the impressive 2 GHz, the Pentium 4, 2 GHz has a quad pumped FSB of 400 MHz and a rapid execution engine for the ALU unit that claims to run at double the core frequency of the processor.

Pentium 4 has a feature set that gives stiff competition to AMD, and now proudly hosts 144 new SSE-2 instructions, whereas AMD has only recently caught up with SSE. And with proposed speeds of over 3000 MHz by the end of 2002, it truly would be tough to beat. Nevertheless, it has its



shortcomings. With a 20-stage-deep pipeline, an expensive memory interface and quick transitions of packaging formats (Socket 423 to 478), one should worry about the longevity of its platform.

Rating: A
Verdict: The Pentium 4, 2 GHz is simply the fastest processor out there in terms of raw power. So if you want to buy the 'fastest' processor in town with the best-of-class build quality, coupled with minimum platform incompatibilities, then the Pentium 4 is your best bet.

The Celeron (Tualatin)

The newer Celeron utilises the 0.13 micron fabrication process, code-named Tualatin, which is probably the most unique and innovative step towards faster speeds and lesser heat dissipation. The Celeron 1.2 GHz performed admirably in our tests. It matched the Duron 1.1 GHz in terms of performance by churning out a score of 61.2 in Content Creation Winstone 2001. Finally, we see the Celeron (Tualatin) maturing to a viable value proposition.

Rating: B
Verdict: The Tualatin suffers from serious platform paucity. The older BX/815 class boards do not support the new voltage requirement that these processors demand. We recommend that you wait for cheaper Tualatin capable boards to be available for the Celeron.



Decision Maker

	 General Desktop use	 Home Entertainment	 Graphics, Professional and Gaming
You need	Decent performance in office productivity applications	Lag-free performance in all graphic, multimedia and video-on-line applications	Movies, music, gaming and complete home entertainment with excellent processing power
Look for	Any of the value processors such as the Celeron 1.0 GHz with speeds to 4,000 MHz	Look for one of the performance processors such as the Pentium III 1.13 GHz (Thunderbird) with speeds to 1,400 MHz	Settle only for the Athlon XP/Pentium 4 processors with speeds to 2,400 MHz
Price	Up to Rs 5,000	Up to Rs 10,000	Rs 10,000 and above
Our pick	Duron 1.1 GHz, Celeron 1.2 GHz	Pentium III 1.13 GHz, Athlon XP 1.2 GHz	Athlon XP 1.2 GHz, Celeron 1.2 GHz, Pentium 4 2.4 GHz

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